

# Sylvan Zheng

New York University Department of Politics  
19 West 4th St, New York, NY 10012

saz310@nyu.edu

sylvanzheng.com

## EDUCATION

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| <b>New York University</b><br><i>PhD Candidate, Wilf Department of Politics</i><br>Dissertation Committee: Pat Egan, Joshua Tucker, Hye Young You | New York, NY<br><i>August 2021 - Present</i> |
| <b>New York University</b><br><i>MPS, Interactive Telecommunications, Tisch School of the Arts</i>                                                | New York, NY<br><i>2019 - 2021</i>           |
| <b>Yale University</b><br><i>BS, Computer Science, cum laude</i>                                                                                  | New Haven, CT<br><i>2013-2017</i>            |

## PEER REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

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2025. “Applications of GPT in Political Science Research: Extracting Information from Unstructured Text” (with Kyuwon Lee, Simone Paci, Jeongmin Park, and Hye Young You), *PS: Political Science & Politics*
2023. “A 2 million-person, campaign-wide field experiment shows how digital advertising affects voter turnout.” (with Minali Aggarwal, Jennifer Allen, Alex Coppock, Solomon Messing, Kelly Zhang, Dan Frankowski, et al) *Nature Human Behaviour*

## WORKING PAPERS

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- “Out of Touch: Economic News and Institutional Trust” (academic job market paper; Revise and Resubmit at *American Political Science Review*)
- “Ambiguity-Robust Dictionaries with Contextualized Embeddings” (with Jamil Citarevese; Under Review)
- When Coverage Diverges from Politics: Source Selection in Climate News (with Hye Young You)
- “Digital Rubbernecking: Consumption vs. Engagement Social Media Feed Optimization” (with Jennifer Allen and Chris Barrie)
- The Prosocial Ranking Challenge: Reducing Polarization on Social Media without Sacrificing Engagement (with Jonathan Stray, George Beknazar-Yuzbashev, Kylan Rutherford, Mateusz Stalinski, and others)

## RELEVANT EMPLOYMENT

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| <b>Local News Lab at Columbia University</b><br><i>Machine Learning Engineer</i>                          | New York, NY<br><i>2021</i>      |
| <b>Acronym</b><br><i>Senior Software Engineer &amp; Data Scientist, Digital Political Ads Measurement</i> | New York, NY<br><i>2020-2021</i> |
| <b>Facebook (Meta)</b><br><i>Software Engineer, Civic Engagement and Election Integrity</i>               | New York, NY<br><i>2017-2019</i> |

## TEACHING

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- Power and Politics in America (Teaching Assistant):** 2026
- PhD Quantitative Methods: Causal Inference (Teaching Assistant):** 2025
- Social Media and Politics: Senior Seminar (Course Assistant):** 2024

## AWARDS, FELLOWSHIPS, AND GRANTS

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- NISS Dissertation Grant (Department Nomination):** 2025
- Institute for Humane Studies Research Award:** 2023
- Light Fellow, Yale University:** 2015

## CONFERENCES AND PRESENTATIONS

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**American Political Science Association:** 2026 (presenter, Political Communication, PACSS pre-conference), 2025

**Data Science Frontiers: Society and Politics:** Fall 2026 (poster presentation)

**Center for Social Media, AI, and Politics Conference:** 2025 (presenter), 2026 (presenter)

**Midwest Political Science Association:** 2024 (presenter)

**Northeast Workshop for Empirical Political Science:** Spring 2026, Fall 2025, Fall 2024 (discussant)

**Money in Politics, Copenhagen:** 2024 (presenter)

**Rebecca Morton Experiments Conference:** 2024, 2023 (poster presentation)

**IC2S2:** 2022 (presenter)

**ITP Tech and Society:** 2020 (presenter)